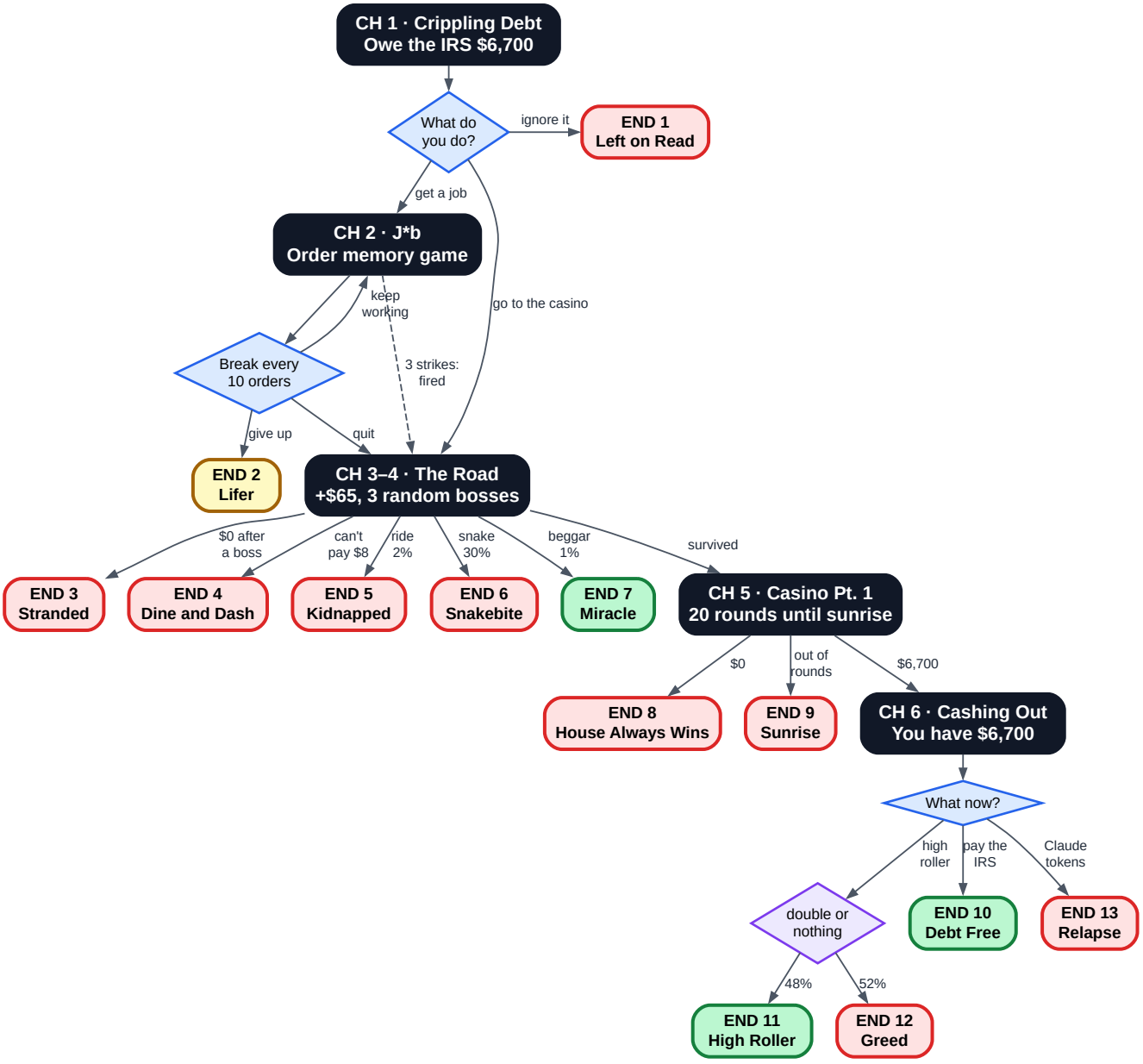
Story Map · The whole game

The story of a man who owes the IRS $6,700
AP Computer Science A · by Rob

HOW IT WORKS

You're a broke college student who skipped your taxes to buy Claude tokens. **Goal:** get `money` to $6,700 and pay the IRS. You start with $0. The job pays $1 per correct order (30 orders max). The road gives you $65, then 3 random bosses out of 5 try to take it. At the casino you have 20 rounds before sunrise, and if you hit $6,700 you still have to decide what to do with it.

13 endings: 4 good or mixed, 9 bad. This page is the summary; pages 2–6 show every step, and page 7 lists every variable.



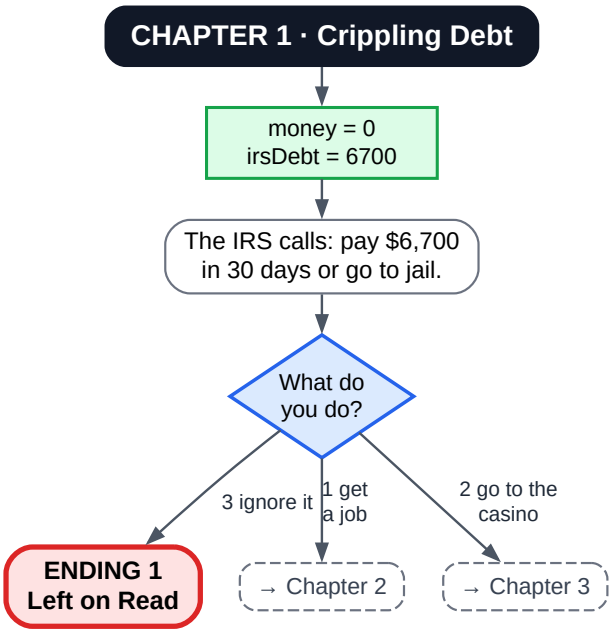
LEGEND (USED ON EVERY PAGE)

Story step	Text the player reads	Choice	Player picks; options on the arrows	Roll	Random chance (Math.random)
Check	An if statement on a variable	money += 1	A variable changes	→ road loop	Continues on another chart
Good ending		Mixed ending		Bad ending	Game over

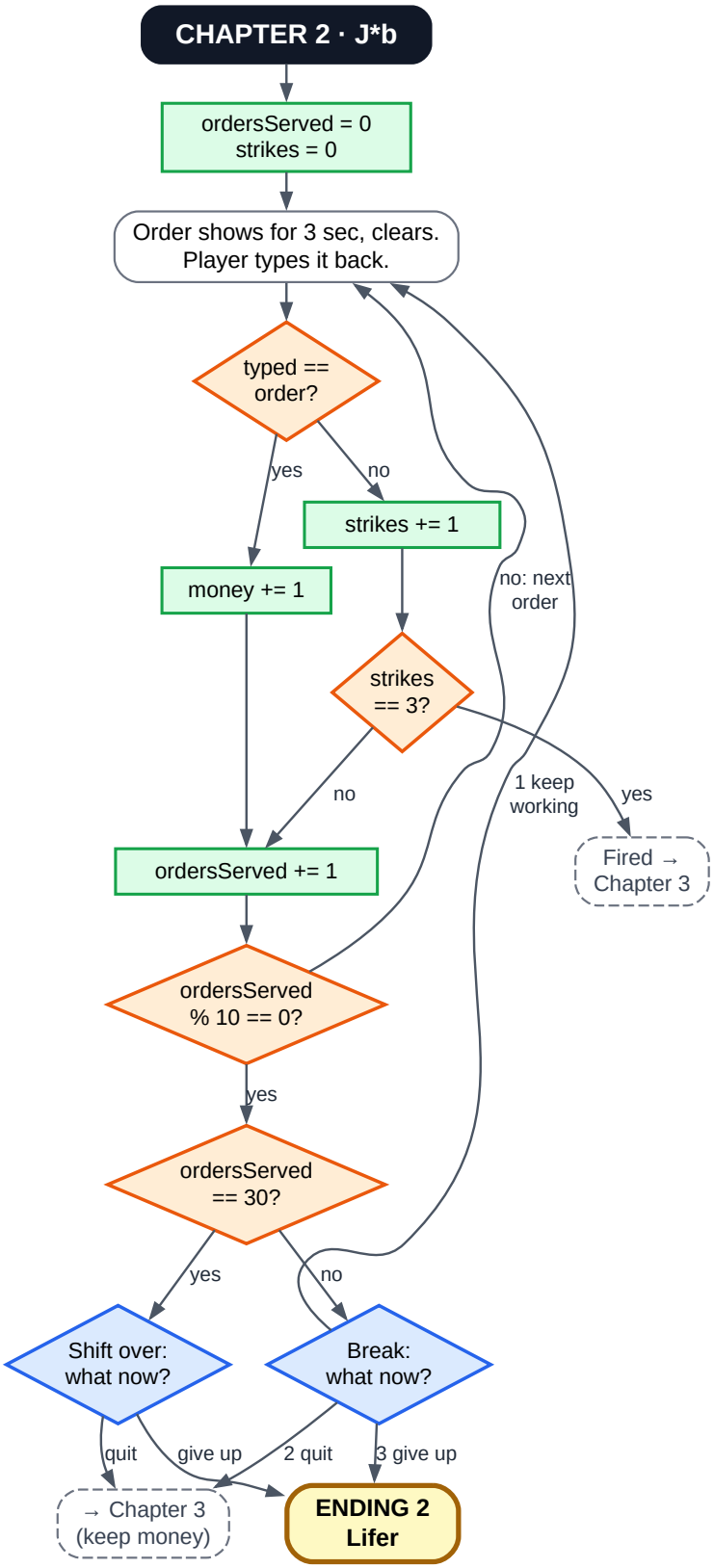
Chapters 1–2 · Debt and the J*b

Green = a variable changes
Orange = a variable is checked

You blew your money on Claude tokens and skipped your taxes. The IRS gives you 30 days.



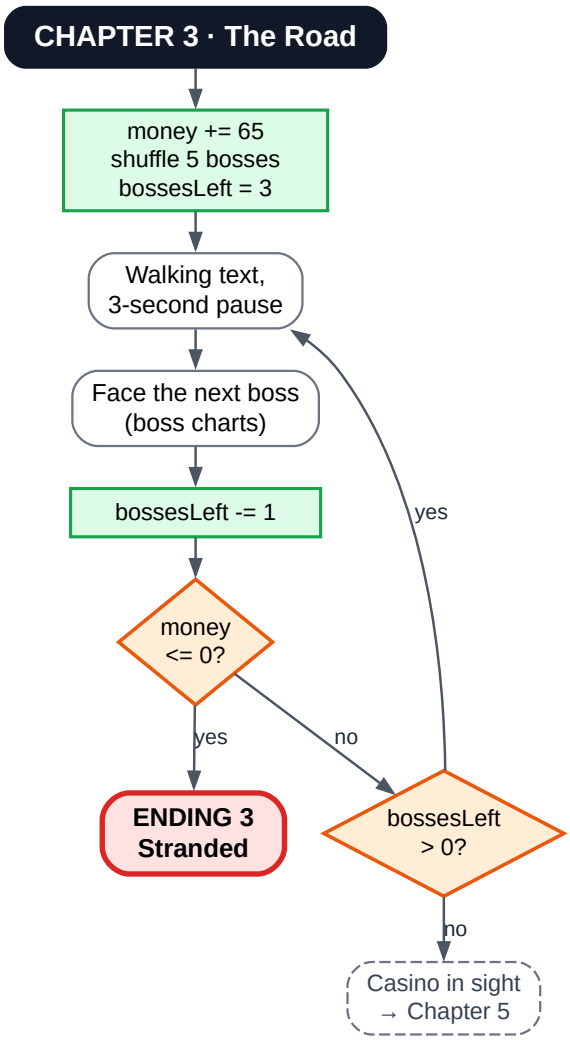
Memory game: an order flashes, you type it back. Right = $1, wrong = a strike. Every 10 orders is a break with a choice. The shift ends at 30 orders, so the job pays $30 at most.



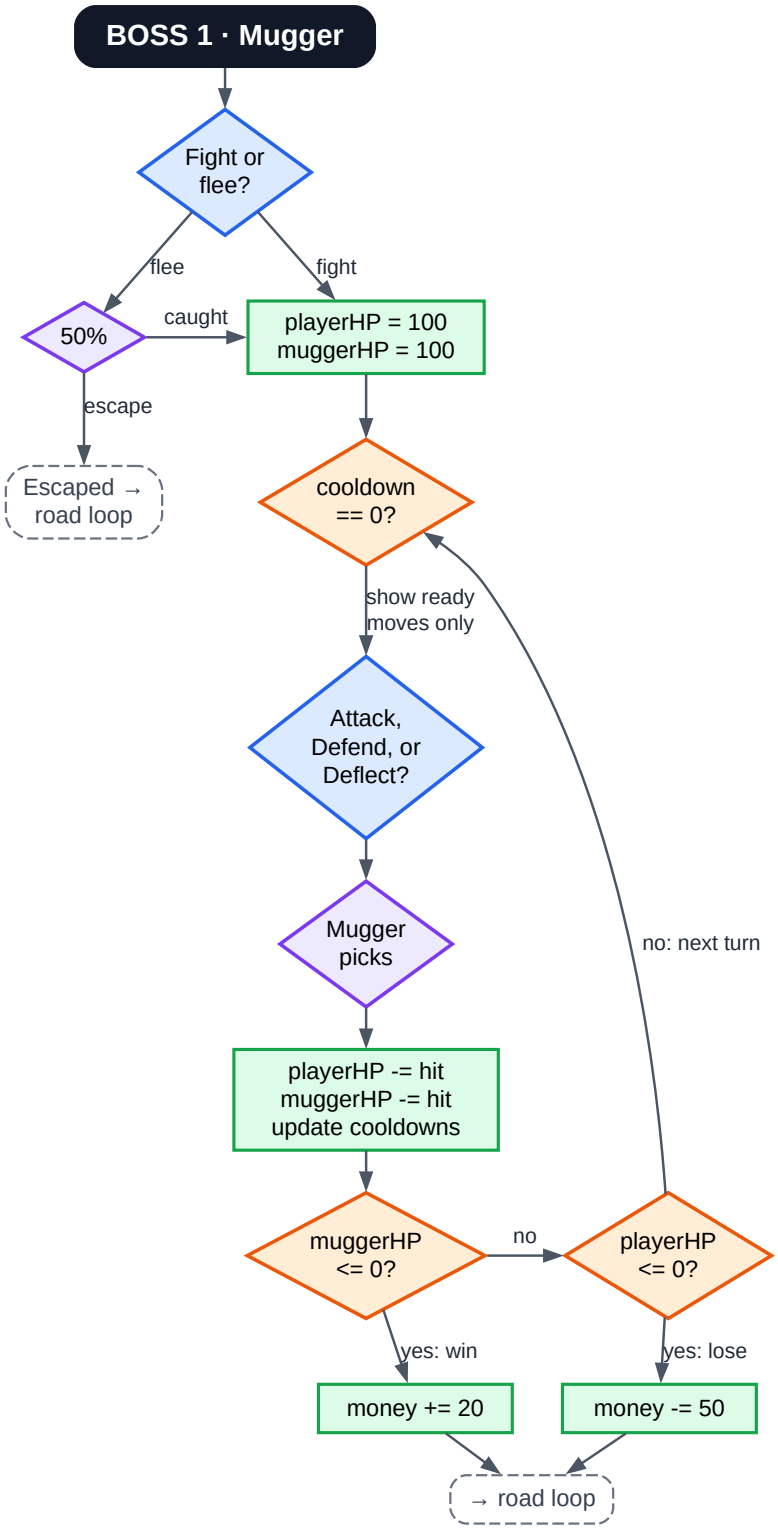
Chapter 3 · The road and Boss 1

You meet 3 of the 5 bosses, shuffled each playthrough

The road is a loop. You find $65 and start walking 50 miles. Every boss chart ends at "→ road loop", which lands on **bossesLeft -= 1** here, so the broke check runs after every boss.

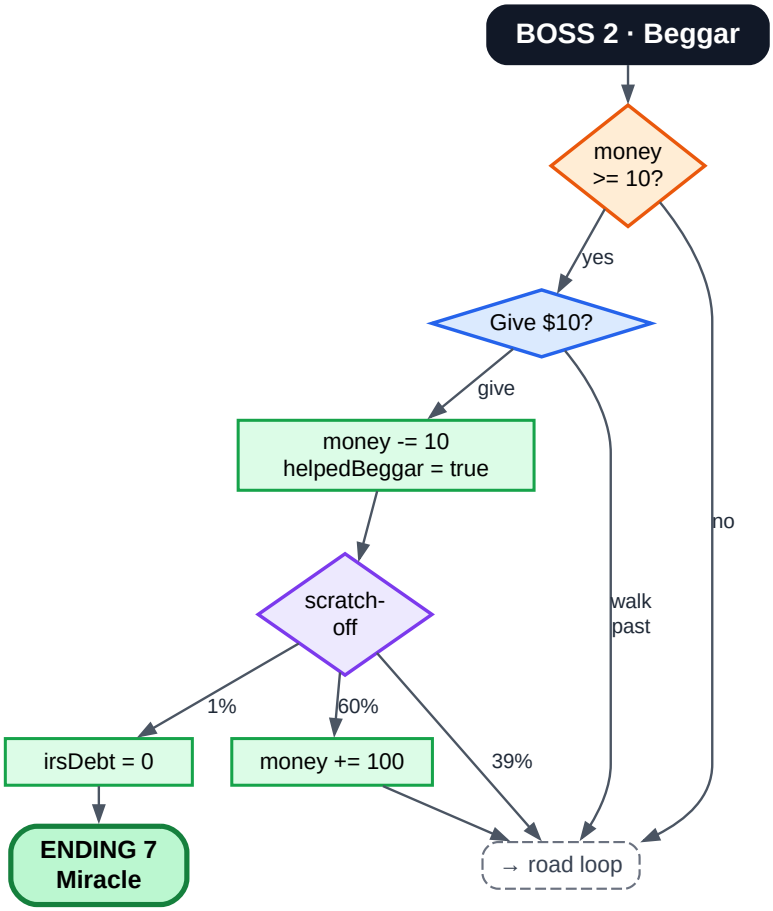


Both start at 100 HP. Attack deals 10–20. Defend halves the hit (1-turn cooldown). Deflect bounces it back (2-turn cooldown). Losing costs $50 (or all you have) but only ends the game if it leaves you at $0.

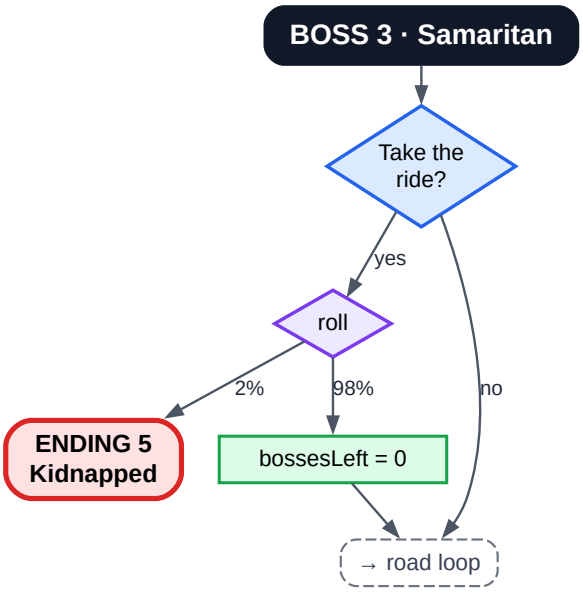


Chapter 4 · Bosses 2–5

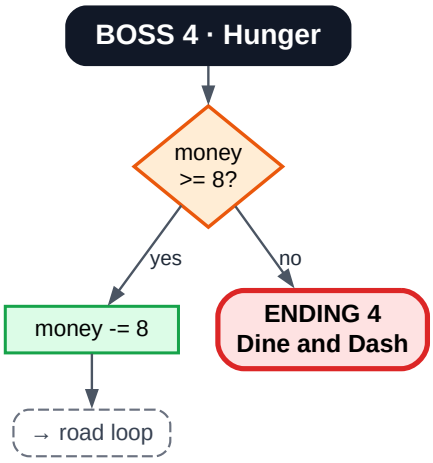
A sweet old lady asks for help. The give option only appears if you can afford it. Giving sets **helpedBeggar**, which pays off at the casino door. 1%: she's the IRS Commissioner's mom.



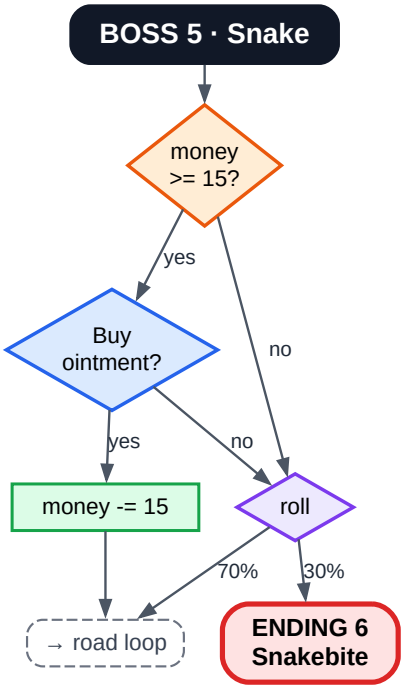
A stranger offers a ride to the casino. It's a shortcut that skips every boss you had left.



You pass a Popeyes, starving. No choice: it checks your wallet. Can't pay? You eat and run, and the cops find your IRS warrant.



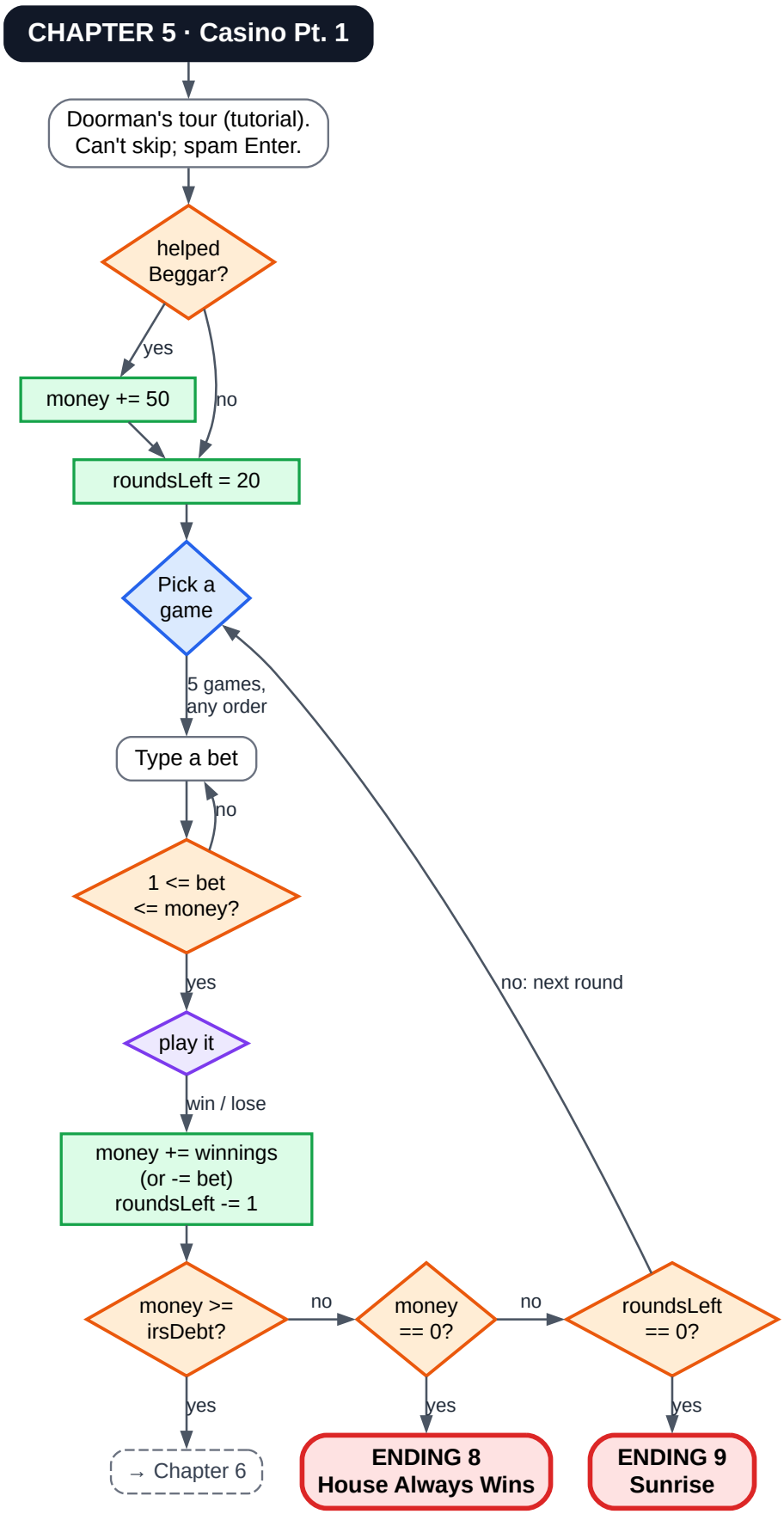
A rattlesnake bites you. Ointment costs $15. Can't afford it? You have to risk it.



Chapter 5 · Casino Pt. 1

20 rounds until sunrise
Play the games in any order

The casino is a loop. After every game, three checks run left to right: rich enough, broke, out of time.



THE GAMES

GAME	PAYOUT
Blackjack	Win 1:1 · blackjack 3:2 · tie returns your bet
Poker	Beat the dealer's 5-card hand, 1:1
Roulette	Color 1:1 · single number 35:1
Slots	3 matching 10:1 · three 7s 50:1
Horse racing	5 horses, 2:1 favorite to 20:1 long shot

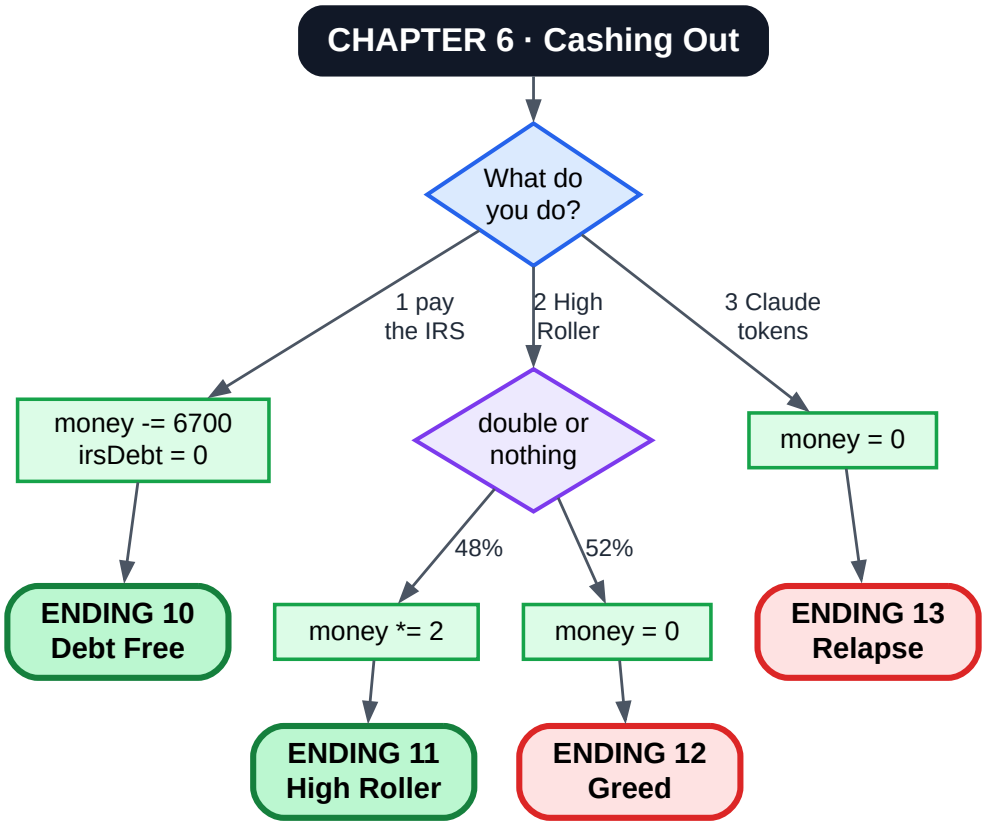
WHY 20 ROUNDS

Going from about $65 to $6,700 means growing your money 100 times over. Safe 1:1 bets can't do that in 20 rounds, so the player has to take long shots. That's the point: the game pushes you to gamble harder as sunrise gets closer.

If you gave the Beggar $10, the doorman says "My grandma told me about you" and hands you a $50 chip.

Chapter 6 · Cashing Out, and every ending

You hit $6,700 and walk to the cashier window. The guy at the High Roller table waves you over. The double-or-nothing bet is 48%, not 50%, because the house always keeps an edge.



ALL 13 ENDINGS

#	ENDING	HOW YOU GET IT	WHAT HAPPENS
1	Left on Read	Ignore the IRS (Ch 1)	Agents knock mid-prompt. Claude tells you to pay your taxes.
2	Lifer	Give up at McDonald's (Ch 2)	22 years of patties. Debt paid. Shift manager.
3	Stranded	Hit $0 after a boss (Ch 3)	Broke on the highway, casino lights 30 miles away.
4	Dine and Dash	Can't pay $8 at Popeyes	Caught running. The cops find the IRS warrant.
5	Kidnapped	Take the Samaritan's ride, 2%	The child locks click.
6	Snakebite	Skip the ointment, 30%	Dead on the shoulder, 20 miles from the slots.
7	Miracle (secret)	Give the Beggar $10, 1%	She's the IRS Commissioner's mom. One call, debt gone.
8	The House Always Wins	Hit $0 at the casino	Security walks you out to the IRS agent in the parking lot.
9	Sunrise	Run out of rounds before $6,700	The deadline passes. They take what you have, and you go to jail anyway.
10	Debt Free	Pay the IRS	You walk out at sunrise owing nobody anything.
11	High Roller	Win double or nothing, 48%	IRS paid, $6,700+ left. You buy a year of Claude Max.
12	Greed	Lose double or nothing, 52%	You had all of it. The IRS agent is waiting in the lobby.
13	Relapse	Spend it all on Claude tokens	Claude writes a great legal defense. It doesn't help.

Tracking variables

Every place a variable changes or gets checked

VARIABLE	STARTS	CHANGES `green box`	CHECKED `orange diamond`
`money` int	0	Job: +1 per correct order Road: +65 Mugger: +20 (win) or −50 (lose) Beggar: −10, then maybe +100 Hunger: −8 · Snake: −15 Casino: +50 chip, then ± every bet Cashing out: −6700, ×2, or = 0	After every boss: ≤ 0? (Stranded) Beggar: ≥ 10? · Hunger: ≥ 8? · Snake: ≥ 15? Every casino bet: 1 ≤ bet ≤ money? After every casino game: ≥ irsDebt? == 0?
`irsDebt` int	6700	Beggar 1%: = 0 Pay the IRS: = 0	After every casino game: money ≥ irsDebt?
`ordersServed` int	0	+1 after every order	% 10 == 0? (break) == 30? (shift over)
`strikes` int	0	+1 per wrong order	== 3? (fired)
`bossesLeft` int	3	−1 after each boss Samaritan ride: = 0	> 0? (keep walking, or reach the casino)
`playerHP`, `muggerHP` int	100, 100	Every fight turn	After every turn: ≤ 0? (someone lost)
`defendCooldown`, `deflectCooldown` int	0, 0	Used: = 1 / = 2 −1 every turn	Before every turn: == 0? (is the move allowed?)
`helpedBeggar` boolean	false	Give the Beggar $10: = true	Casino door: true? ($50 chip)
`roundsLeft` int	20	−1 after every casino game	After every casino game: == 0? (Sunrise)

RANDOM ROLLS `purple diamond`

Which 3 bosses you meet (shuffle) · fleeing the mugger, 50% · the mugger's move each turn · the Beggar's ticket, 1% / 60% / 39% · the Samaritan, 2% · toughing out the snake bite, 30% · every casino game · the High Roller bet, 48%.

MONEY CHECK: CAN YOU EVEN REACH THE CASINO?

Worst case straight from Chapter 1: $65, lose to the mugger (−$50 → $15), give the Beggar $10 (→ $5), then Popeyes needs $8 → Ending 4. A job run adds up to $30, which is enough to survive that same road. So the job is worth something even though it can't pay the IRS.